



With the launch of the Ayushman Bharat project, this system has been extended to hundreds of wellness centres across the state as well. By 2022, all 793 Primary Health Care Centres and 5200 Secondary Health Care Centres got a make-over and were upgraded to wellness centres. The number of Ayushman card holders also rose quickly enabling more beneficiaries easy access to the free health facility in all government and recognized hospitals in the state, which have also increased in numbers to serve a larger population.

Fortifying Healthcare Infrastructure

CM Baghel led government maintained simultaneous focus on increasing the health infrastructure by increasing the number of Medical College Hospitals (MCHs), district hospitals and civil hospitals in the state. For taking healthcare to the grassroots sub-health centers and community health center have also been established and are functional to the optimum. Reciprocally, the number of medical staff including

specialists, doctors, medical officers, staff nurses, lab technicians, and rural health coordinators (women), rose significantly in numbers within a span of two years. The Chhattisgarh government is supportive of private enterprise in healthcare and also encourages Public Private Partnerships for creating a more conducive environment for the healthcare sector to grow through knowledge and skill sharing of the latest practices in the domain. The state is rapidly developing into a healthcare hub with innovative and proactive approach of the state government. Chhattisgarh has much to offer in terms of choices ranging from the modern to the ancient tradition of Ayurveda, which is prevalent and being a repository of a variety of medicinal herbs and plants that grow in the abundant natural flora of the state. The state government is exploring every possibility to offer an attractive portfolio with a range of choices covering a wide spectrum of healthcare services alongwith the people availing the facility coming from every strata of society.

Affordability, infrastructure and resources continue to be challenges which the Chhattisgarh government is tackling on priority and with political resolve. Therefore, the state scheme known as Mukhyamantri Swasthya Bima Yojana (MSBY), is seen as another significant impetus in healthcare benefitting lakhs of people because of its wide extent of coverage and also the insurance amount limit has been raised. The Chhattisgarh MSBY was the first scheme launched anywhere in India aimed at providing universal health coverage. MSBY provides free medical coverage for all citizens, and not just those below the poverty line, and it also has a higher limit at Rs. 50,000 as opposed to 30,000 under RSBY, the national scheme. By leveraging technology as an enabler, lakhs of families have benefited from the digitally health insurance system where smart cards are used to deliver insurance coverage at hospitals.

As part of the Digital India campaign, the reach of internet connectivity is being exploited to the optimum for expansion of health services to rural areas in Chhattisgarh. Under the Village/Rural Entrepreneurship scheme, all 27 district medical hospitals across the state are linked with medical colleges, digitally. The deep penetration of internet connectivity is enabling patients to consult and avail the services of specialist doctors in the comfort of their homes without being restricted by geographical boundaries, besides saving on fringe costs. Chhattisgarh has a vast forest terrain and many interior pockets where the population is scant. These extremely

